Excel PivotTable Basics — Veda Technology Internship

Project summary

This beginner-level sales analysis summarizes the Sample Superstore transactions by product category, region, and month-year. The analysis was calculated from the supplied workbook, and the original `RawData` worksheet has been preserved in the output workbook.

Dataset verification

- **Source file:** `Sample-Superstore.xlsx`
- **Worksheet:** `RawData`
- **Verified used range:** `RawData!A1:U9995` (header plus 9,994 data records)
- **Fields checked:** `Order Date`, `Region`, `Category`, and numeric `Sales`
- **Order Date range:** January 3, 2014 to December 30, 2017
- **Total sales across the records: $2,297,200.86**
- The provided workbook has 21 columns (A:U). Its actual last used row is 9995; the frequently expected 9994 is the number of data records, not the last worksheet row when the header is included.

Results

Sales by category

Category	Sum of Sales
Technology	$836,154.03
Furniture	$741,999.80
Office Supplies	$719,047.03
Grand Total	**$2,297,200.86**

Finding: Technology had the highest sales; Office Supplies had the lowest sales.

Sales by region

Region	Sum of Sales
West	$725,457.82
East	$678,781.24
Central	$501,239.89
South	$391,721.91
Grand Total	**$2,297,200.86**

Finding: West had the highest sales; South had the lowest sales.

Monthly sales trend

The monthly summary contains 48 year-month rows (2014–2017), in chronological order, with years kept separate. **November 2017** had the highest month-year sales at **$118,447.83**. Monthly results vary across the period, with several of the strongest totals occurring in later months; the reported peak itself is November 2017. Review the complete `Monthly Sales Trend` worksheet before making a stronger claim about seasonality.

Workbook contents

`Excel_PivotTable_Basics.xlsx` contains these tabs:

1. **Insights** — verified key findings, source validation, conclusion, and implementation note.
2. **Sales by Category** — category sales, descending order, two-decimal currency formatting, and Grand Total.
3. **Sales by Region** — region sales, descending order, two-decimal currency formatting, and Grand Total.
4. **Monthly Sales Trend** — month-year sales in chronological order and Grand Total.
5. **RawData** — the original source records preserved with readable date/sales formatting.

Important implementation note

The summary sheets are verified, PivotTable-style aggregated tables. **They are not native, refreshable Excel PivotTable objects.** The workbook-generation method available here can preserve the raw worksheet and create well-formatted calculated summaries, but it

does not create Excel's native PivotTable cache/object. The step-by-step guide explains how to recreate the summaries as native PivotTables in Microsoft Excel. No claim is made that native PivotTables were embedded.

If the source data changes, these static summary values will not update automatically. Recalculate the summaries or recreate them as native PivotTables using the guide.

Key learnings

- A PivotTable groups detailed records into categories and calculates totals quickly.
- `Rows` determines the groups; `Values` contains the measure being summarized.
- `Sales` should be summarized by **Sum**, not Count, to compare sales amounts.
- Grouping dates by both year and month avoids combining, for example, January 2014 and January 2017.
- Always verify source headers, data types, row count, and full range before analyzing.

Files

- `Excel_PivotTable_Basics.xlsx` — completed analysis workbook.
- `README_Excel_PivotTable_Basics.md` — this project summary.
- `Step_by_Step_Guide_Excel_PivotTables.md` — beginner instructions and interview questions.

Suggested review and submission steps

1. Open the workbook and review the `Insights` tab.
2. Check the totals on all three summary tabs; each Grand Total should be **$2,297,200.86**.
3. Review `RawData` to confirm the source records remain available.
4. If your internship requires native PivotTables, use the guide to recreate them in Excel and verify that the results match this workbook.
5. Submit the workbook and the two Markdown project documents. Do not claim the project was uploaded to GitHub unless you do that separately.